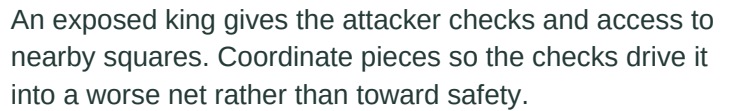


Exposed-king tactics

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Inspect open files, diagonals, and unprotected squares around the king. Calculate checks in an order that preserves the attack.

The defending king is on d8. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8 and queen on f3. Check for tactical protection.

Previous move: 32...Kd8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

33. Ba5+ b6 34. Bxb6+ Ke8 35. Nd6#

33.Ba5+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **33...b6.**

34.Bxb6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on b6. Recorded reply: **34...Ke8**.

35.Nd6# Mate: knight on d6 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on e8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Knight on d6. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

A king without pawns is not automatically mated. Count active attackers and examine escapes toward friendly pieces.